PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 3

Arsenal v Chelsea

Emirates Stadium, London · September 6, 2026 (Sunday) · Kickoff 10:30 AM Central / 16:30 UK

OFFICIAL STARTING XI

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
1 GK	**Emiliano Martínez** GOALKEEPER	Argentina	August 2026, £7.5m from Aston Villa — signed the morning…	Aston Villa; Arsenal; loans at Oxford United, Sheffield…	World Cup winner and a renowned penalty specialist — commanding, vocal, and a serial big-moment goalkeeper.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 95 saves, 32 apps
34 RCB	**Josh Acheampong** CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy graduate; first-team regular from 2026	Chelsea academy	Composed young centre-back who reads danger early and is comfortable stepping into midfield with the ball.	—
29 CB	**Wesley Fofana** CENTRE-BACK	France	Since Aug 2022, about £70m from Leicester City	Leicester City; Saint-Étienne	Quick, aggressive and front-footed, strong in single combat and comfortable defending a high line.	2025–26, CHELSEA 25 apps, 1,727 minutes
5 LCB	**Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK	France	July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace	Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux	Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed.	2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets
7 RWB	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
24 CM	**Reece James** RIGHT CENTRE-BACK · CAPTAIN	England	Academy from 2005; senior squad since 2019 — 8th…	Chelsea academy; Wigan Athletic (loan, 2018/19)	Club captain.	2025–26, CHELSEA 27 apps, 4 assists
45 CM	**Romeo Lavia** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Belgium	Since Aug 2023 from Southampton	Southampton; Manchester City academy; Anderlecht academy	Press-resistant holding midfielder who turns out of pressure and keeps the ball moving in tight areas.	2025–26, CHELSEA — INJURY-HIT 8 apps
21 LWB	**Jorrel Hato** LEFT WING-BACK / CENTRE-BACK	Netherlands	Since Aug 2025, £35.5m plus add-ons — 2nd season	Ajax; Sparta Rotterdam academy	Left-footed, positionally mature well beyond his age, and more defender than flying full-back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 22 apps (12 starts)
10 AM	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
9 ST	**João Pedro** CENTRE-FORWARD	Brazil	Since July 2025, £55m plus £5m	Brighton; Watford; Fluminense	Mobile, link-heavy forward rather than a target man: drops between the lines, spins in behind, presses from the front.	2025–26, CHELSEA 15 goals, 5 assists

Official starting XI, confirmed 9:38 AM CT. Last updated September 6, 2026, 10:15 AM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app